

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom

First Flight - prose | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

What does Mandela mean by saying that both the oppressor and the oppressed are robbed of their humanity?

Answer:

The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Mandela argues that injustice damages everyone, so both must be freed from hatred and fear.

Question 2

How did Mandela's understanding of courage change?

Answer:

He once thought courage meant having no fear. Experience taught him that courage is the triumph over fear: a brave person feels fear but acts despite it.

Question 3

Explain the two obligations Mandela describes in a person's life.

Answer:

A person has duties to family and to society or country. Under apartheid, unjust laws made it difficult for Mandela to honour both, so the struggle for freedom became necessary.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

The central focus is: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

First point: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Second point: He once thought courage meant having no fear. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Then connect it to the result: He once thought courage meant having no fear.

Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Mandela argues that injustice damages everyone, so both must be freed from hatred and fear. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

He once thought courage meant having no fear. Experience taught him that courage is the triumph over fear: a brave person feels fear but acts despite it. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: A person has duties to family and to society or country.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

The first idea is: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. The second idea is: He once thought courage meant having no fear. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Effect or outcome: He once thought courage meant having no fear. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Next, He once thought courage meant having no fear. Finally, A person has duties to family and to society or country.

Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Add one supporting point: He once thought courage meant having no fear. End with the outcome or message: A person has duties to family and to society or country.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: He once thought courage meant having no fear. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

A sound inference is that a person has duties to family and to society or country. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Then justify the response with: He once thought courage meant having no fear.

Question 18

What would make an answer from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Also add: A person has duties to family and to society or country.

Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

Assertion: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Reason: He once thought courage meant having no fear. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - He once thought courage meant having no fear.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Use three connected points: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. He once thought courage meant having no fear. A person has duties to family and to society or country. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. He once thought courage meant having no fear. - and close with: A person has duties to family and to society or country. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: He once thought courage meant having no fear.

Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom - Continued

Question 24

Which detail from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: A person has duties to family and to society or country. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: A person has duties to family and to society or country. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

1. The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. 2. He once thought courage meant having no fear. 3. A person has duties to family and to society or country. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: He once thought courage meant having no fear.

Question 28

Why does Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. He once thought courage meant having no fear. A person has duties to family and to society or country.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom.

Answer:

Opening: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. Development: He once thought courage meant having no fear. Conclusion: A person has duties to family and to society or country. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom - Continued

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about Nelson Mandela - Long Walk to Freedom?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: The oppressor becomes cruel and loses compassion, while the oppressed are denied freedom and dignity. and He once thought courage meant having no fear.

Sources: [CBSE English curriculum 2026-27](#); [CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27](#); [NCERT textbooks](#).

ONE SHOT MASTERY